

Vegetable Gardening for Seniors - Planning Sheets

From *Vegetable Gardening for Seniors* by Helen Marchbank (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The Sowing and Harvest Calendar

I = sow indoors or on the windowsill; **O** = sow or plant outdoors; **H** = harvest. Temperate northern climate; shift by two to four weeks either way for a warmer or colder place (Chapter 7), and by six months for the southern hemisphere. The profiles in Part 2 give the month within each pair.

Vegetable	Jan-Feb	Mar-Apr	May-Jun	Jul-Aug	Sep-Oct	Nov-Dec
Lettuce		O	O H	O H	H	
Rocket		O H	O H	O H	O H	
Spinach		O	O H	O	O H	H
Radish		O H	O H	O H	O H	
Spring Onion		O	O H	O H	O H	
Mixed Salad Leaves	I	O H	O H	O H	O H	I
Carrot		O	O H	O H	H	H
Beetroot		O	O H	O H	H	
Potato	I	I O	H	H		
Onion		O	H	H	O	

Garlic	O		H	H	O	O
Turnip		O	OH	OH	H	H
Runner Bean		I	IO	H	H	
French Bean		I	IOH	OH	H	
Pea		O	OH	H	OH	
Tomato		I	O	H	H	
Cucumber		I	IO	H	H	
Courgette		I	IO	H	H	
Kale	H	OH	O	O	H	H
Cabbage		IH	OH	IOH	OH	
Broccoli	H	IH	IOH	OH	H	
Pak Choi		I		O	OH	
Leek	H	OH	O	O	H	H
Perpetual Spinach	H	OH	H	OH	H	H
Strawberry		O	H	OH	OH	
Rhubarb	O	OH	H	H		O

Sweet Pepper	I	I	O	H	H	
Chilli Pepper	I	I	O	H	H	H
Winter Squash		I	IO		H	
Pea Shoots and Microgreens	I H	I H	I H	I H	I H	I H

The Container, Spacing and Water Chart

The smallest sensible container for each crop, how many plants it takes or how far apart they go in a bed, and how thirsty the crop is (1 = forgives a dry week; 3 = daily in summer). A bigger pot is always easier than a smaller one: it dries out slower.

Vegetable	Smallest container	Plants per pot, or spacing in a bed	Thirst	Sun
Lettuce	30 cm pot or trough	5 to 6 loose-leaf; 25 cm hearting	2	Sun, shade in July
Rocket	20 to 30 cm pot	a band, thinned to 10 cm	2	Sun or part shade
Spinach	30 cm pot	6; 10 to 20 cm	2	Sun, shade in summer
Radish	20 cm pot or window box	12; 3 cm	2	Sun or light shade
Spring Onion	20 cm pot	a clump of 30	1	Sun
Mixed Salad Leaves	seed tray 8 cm deep	broadcast	2	Sun or part shade
Carrot	30 cm deep pot	20 short; 5 cm	2	Sun
Beetroot	30 cm pot	5 to 6; 10 cm	2	Sun or light shade
Potato	40 litre bag or bin	3 seed potatoes; 30 cm	3	Sun
Onion	deep window box	a row; 10 cm	1	Sun
Garlic	30 cm pot	5; 15 cm	1	Sun

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Turnip	30 cm pot	6 to 8; 10 cm	2	Sun or light shade
Runner Bean	45 cm pot with a wigwam	2 per cane; 15 cm	3	Sun, sheltered
French Bean	30 cm pot	6 dwarf; 15 cm	2	Sun
Pea	30 cm pot with a frame	8; a double row 5 cm	2	Sun or light shade
Tomato	30 cm pot, 10 litres	1; 45 cm	3	Full sun
Cucumber	30 cm pot up a cane	1; 60 cm	3	Full sun, sheltered
Courgette	45 cm pot, 30 litres	1; 1 m	3	Full sun
Kale	30 cm pot	1; 45 cm	1	Sun or part shade
Cabbage	30 cm pot	1; 30 to 45 cm	2	Sun
Broccoli	bed (calabrese 30 cm pot)	30 cm; sprouting 60 cm	2	Sun
Pak Choi	30 cm pot or tray	6; 20 cm	2	Sun, shade in summer
Leek	30 cm deep pot (baby leeks)	7 to 8; 15 cm	1	Sun or light shade
Perpetual Spinach	30 cm pot	4; 20 to 30 cm	1	Sun or part shade
Strawberry	30 cm pot, basket or planter	3; 35 cm	2	Full sun
Rhubarb	50 cm pot or half-barrel	1; 1 m	2	Sun or light shade
Sweet Pepper	25 to 30 cm pot	1; 40 cm	2	Full sun, sill or porch
Chilli Pepper	15 to 25 cm pot	1	1	Full sun, the sill
Winter Squash	45 cm pot or half-barrel	1; 1.5 m	3	Full sun
Pea Shoots	seed tray or	shoulder to	2	Any bright

and Microgreens	takeaway box	shoulder		sill
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The bed plan (eight squares of 60 cm; or draw your own pots)

	Square 1	Square 2	Square 3	Square 4
Spring (Mar to May)				
Summer (Jun to Aug)				
Autumn and winter				
	Square 5	Square 6	Square 7	Square 8
Spring (Mar to May)				
Summer (Jun to Aug)				
Autumn and winter				

The pots and bags

Pot or bag	Size	Where it stands (sun hours)	Crop	Sown or planted

The sowing log

Date	Crop and variety	Seed or plant	Where (square or pot)	Up on	Planted out	Notes

The harvest log

Date	Crop	How much (handful, bowl, colander)	Eaten, kept, given	Worth the space?

The weekly ten minutes

(tick as done)

This week	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa	Su
Pots watered (finger test)							
Bed watered (twice a week in dry weather)							
Slugs and caterpillars checked							
Beans, courgettes, cucumbers picked							
Salad cut							
Tomatoes tied in and side-shooted							
Something sown (every two to three weeks)							
Feed (weekly for pots after six weeks)							
Nets and covers checked							

My cautions (from the doctor or pharmacist, if any)

Medicine or condition	Vegetable to keep steady or in moderation	What was said